

Recruitment Email Template

Subject: Invitation to participate in research on housing opposition and planning in Austin

Dear [Name],

My name is Daniel Lewis, and I am a master's student in Urban Planning at Columbia University, working under the supervision of Professor Hiba Bou Akar. I am conducting a research project on patterns of neighborhood opposition to housing development in Austin and the role of data and technology in planning and public engagement.

I am writing to invite you to take part in a 45–60 minute semi-structured interview about your experiences with housing, zoning, and public participation in Austin. I am especially interested in hearing from stakeholders such as city officials and planners, neighborhood association leaders, housing advocates, developers, and civic technologists who have been directly involved in these processes.

If you choose to participate, I would ask you about: - How you see neighborhood opposition to housing projects in Austin. - Your experiences with public meetings, protest petitions, or other forms of participation. - Your views on whether and how data and predictive tools should be used in planning and zoning decisions.

Your participation is completely voluntary. You may decline to answer any question or stop the interview at any time. With your permission, the interview will be audio-recorded to ensure accuracy; if you prefer not to be recorded, I will rely on written notes instead.

If you are interested, I will send you a written consent form with more details about the study, risks, and protections for confidentiality.

If you would be willing to participate, or if you have any questions, please feel free to contact me at dl3645@columbia.edu.

Thank you for considering this invitation.

Best regards, Daniel Lewis M.S. Urban Planning Graduate School of Architecture, Planning and Preservation (GSAPP) Columbia University Email: dl3645@columbia.edu

IRB Contact at Columbia (Morningside) If you have questions about your rights or welfare as a research participant, you may contact: Columbia University Morningside Institutional Review Board (IRB) Phone: (212) 851-7040 Email: AskIRB@columbia.edu